YOU ARE HERE Step 9 of 9, Maintain · 9.1 Maintain Eligibility

Where You Are: The Maintain Step, the Last of Nine, and What Continues After It

The nine steps of the Medicaid Planning Roadmap, with yours marked.

For months the road led to one thing, the approval. Now Mom has it, and it would be easy to think the road stops there. There is one more step, and it is a routine more than a push.

This page shows the whole road, where the Maintain step sits on it, what it produces, and who does which part from here.

Phase 1 · Assess

Understand where you are today.

1. **Understand** Care Needs → Levels of Care & Costs → Care Plan
   You finish with: Immediate Care Needs Assessment
2. **Organize** Income & Assets → Ownership & Expenses → Financial File
   You finish with: Financial Snapshot & Care Cost Analysis
3. **Assess** Care & Nonfinancial Eligibility → Income & Assets → Barriers & Readiness
   You finish with: Medicaid Readiness Assessment

Phase 2 · Plan

Develop and implement your strategy.

4. **Plan** Barriers & Issues → Priorities & Professional Team → Written Plan
   You finish with: Medicaid Action Plan
5. **Legal** Authority & Documents → Property, Trusts & Transfers → Attorney Review
   You finish with: Legal Issues & Attorney Review Brief
6. **Financial** Costs & Runway → Asset Treatment & Tools → Strategy & Documentation
   You finish with: Financial Strategy & Implementation Plan

Phase 3 · Secure

Secure benefits, protect assets, and maintain eligibility.

7. **Apply** Prepare → Submit → Manage
   You finish with: Medicaid Application File
8. **Protect** What May Be Protected → What May Remain Exposed → What Needs Ongoing Attention
   You finish with: Asset Protection Report

9 **Maintain** Ongoing Requirements → Changes & Renewals → Maintenance System

You finish with: Medicaid Maintenance Plan

You are here. This step is about keeping up with Medicaid now that Mom has it. It moves from what the approval letter asks of the family, to changes and renewals, to a simple system for staying on top of both. You finish it with an ongoing system meant to keep Mom's Medicaid eligibility in good standing and to catch a possible problem early.

What came before it

Eight steps come before this one. The first three build the picture: Mom's care needs, her finances, and where things stand with Medicaid. The next three turn the picture into a plan and take its legal and financial questions to the professionals they belong to. Then come Apply and Protect, in the same phase as this step.

If your family came to the roadmap at the application, or after it, this step can still start from the approval letter and whatever is already in the folder.

What this step produces

The Medicaid Maintenance Plan: a renewal calendar, the reporting requirements as they apply to Mom, a monitoring checklist, a document system, and what the family does when something changes. It is put together with your Medicaid planner, from Mom's own notices.

It is a routine, not a decision about eligibility. The state makes that decision and looks at it again: a renewal is the state reviewing a person's information to decide whether they still qualify, and states are required to do this periodically. [1] [2]

What continues from here

This is the last of the nine steps, so what comes next isn't another step. It is the routine itself: the mail opened, the dates kept, the changes written down, and a periodic review with your Medicaid planner of notices, renewals, records and what has changed since the last one.

The state's part continues too. The federal renewal flyer says the state mails a letter about a person's coverage, and that the letter says whether a form or other information is needed. Medicaid.gov's directory of state agencies is where to find who to ask about a renewal. [1] [3]

When a significant financial or legal change comes up, it is reviewed with your Medicaid planner before anything is done, and legal questions go to an elder law attorney. The Family Caregiver Alliance lists a local Area Agency on Aging, a state senior legal hotline, or an attorney who specializes in elder law as ways to find legal help. [4]

Who does which part, by role

- You and your family: opening the mail, keeping the folder and the calendar, writing down what changes, and asking before acting.
- Mom: her own wishes, as far as she can share them.
- Your Medicaid planner: goes through the approval notice, the ongoing obligations and the renewal requirements with the family, reviews significant financial or legal changes with them before any action that could affect eligibility, and holds a periodic review.
- The state Medicaid agency: sends the notices, carries out the renewals and decides eligibility. Its own letters are the authority on Mom's dates and requirements.
- An elder law attorney: legal questions and legal documents.
- A licensed financial or insurance professional: questions about a financial or insurance product, if one comes up.

What this page doesn't promise

How long anything takes, who will be available, or how things turn out. It doesn't say that Mom's coverage will continue; the state decides that at each review. Families settle into this routine at different speeds. Nothing here is legal, financial or tax advice.

Ready for the next step?

You know where this step sits, who does which part and what continues from here. The planning interview is a way to bring your own family's situation to it: it asks about where things stand and gives you a free planning report you can bring to your Medicaid planner, or to any conversation about paying for care.

Get Your Free Planning Report ›

WHERE THIS COMES FROM

The nine steps are the Medicaid Planning Roadmap's own. The statements about renewals and the state's letters come from the Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services and Justice in Aging, the directory of state agencies is Medicaid.gov's, and the ways to find legal help are the Family Caregiver Alliance's.

1. Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services (CMS), Have Medicaid or CHIP? Get ready to renew your coverage
2. Justice in Aging, Final Rule to Streamline Access to Medicaid
3. Medicaid.gov (Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services), Where Can People Get Help With Medicaid & CHIP?
4. Family Caregiver Alliance, What should I do to help get my family member's legal and financial affairs in order?